

RFP Analysis Report

Source: 361_rfp_RFP_Exhibit_A__B__C.pdf

GO

75
FIT SCORE

This RFP presents a strong strategic fit for SPS, aligning well with its core AI/ML and web development capabilities. While financial terms appear manageable, the lack of explicit payment terms and detailed insurance requirements introduces some minor uncertainty. The tight deadline and the need for a proposal bond are key considerations, but overall, this is a promising opportunity given SPS's expertise.

Component	Score	Weight	Note
Strategic Fit	90/100	30%	SPS's profile explicitly lists AI/ML-driven solutions (search, personalization, data platforms) and web application development and integration, which directly aligns with the RFP's purpose of an AI-driven enterprise website search and personalization solution.
Financial Terms Fit	70/100	20%	The RFP requires a proposal bond for values over \$500,000, which is manageable. Payment terms are not specified, which introduces some uncertainty but is generally negotiable. Insurance requirements are not detailed, but SPS's max insurance available is \$5,000,000, which should be sufficient for most contracts of this nature.
Compliance Readiness	71/100	30%	Computed directly from the compliance checklist's overall score — not separately judged by the AI.
Risk Level (100=low risk)	65/100	20%	The submission deadline is tight (July 7, 2026), requiring prompt action. The requirement for a proposal bond adds a financial commitment upfront. Ambiguity exists regarding specific contract value and detailed insurance requirements, which could lead to unforeseen obligations. The need to register in Virginia on a per-bid basis adds a procedural risk.

Compliance Readiness is computed directly from the Compliance Checklist's overall score, not separately judged by the AI.

Department / Category	Score	Recommendation	Summary
OVERALL COMPLIANCE	71.4%	Review Needed	Score is 71% — requires review for: Payment Terms, Financial Stability Requirements, Unaudited Financial Statements, Insurance Requirements, Profitability Analysis, Relevant Experience, Financial Statement of Previous Year, Qualified Personnel, Expected Revenue Generation, Period of Implementation, Insurance Coverage, E-Verify, Contractual Obligations, Insurance Requirement Form, MBE Certification, Workers Comp Insurance, Business with Iran, Checklist of Required Documents, Compliance with Industry Standards, Security Considerations.
Financial / Accounting	58.3%	Review Needed	Score is 58% — requires review for: Payment Terms, Financial Stability Requirements, Unaudited Financial Statements, Insurance Requirements, Profitability Analysis.

Department / Category	Score	Recommendation	Summary
Legal	69.2%	Review Needed	Score is 69% — requires review for: Relevant Experience, Financial Statement of Previous Year, Qualified Personnel, Expected Revenue Generation, Period of Implementation, Insurance Coverage, E-Verify, Contractual Obligations.
Operations	77.3%	Review Needed	Score is 77% — requires review for: Insurance Requirement Form, MBE Certification, Workers Comp Insurance, Business with Iran, Checklist of Required Documents.
Technical	80.0%	Review Needed	Score is 80% — requires review for: Compliance with Industry Standards, Security Considerations.

Scores are computed directly from the checklist below (GO=100, REVIEW=50, NO-GO=0, averaged per department), not separately judged by the AI.

Deliverables

9 deliverables · 14 days estimated total

1. Signed Proposal **[High]** (Mandatory · 1d)

1.1 Proposal must be signed by an agent authorized to bind the company. *(Page 1)*

1.2 Include Name and Address of Contractor, Date, Signature, Typed or Printed Name and Title, FEI/FIN #, Phone, Fax, Email. *(Page 1)*

2. eVA Registration Confirmation **[High]** (Mandatory · 0d)

2.1 Indicate if registered with eVA and provide eVA ID #. *(Page 1)*

3. State Corporation Commission (SEC) Registration Confirmation **[High]** (Mandatory · 0d)

3.1 Indicate if registered with the Commonwealth's State Corporation Commission and provide identification number. *(Page 1)*

4. Sealed Proposal Envelope/Package **[High]** (Mandatory · 0d)

4.1 Envelope/package must be sealed and identified with Contractor Name, Address, RFP Number (26-ODU-30-JNH), RFP Title (AI-driven Enterprise Website Search and Personalization Solution), and Name of Procurement Officer (Janis Hall). *(I.C, Page 2)*

4.2 Addressed as directed on Page 1 of the solicitation. *(I.C, Page 2)*

4.3 No other correspondence or proposals should be placed in the envelope. *(I.C, Page 2)*

5. Proposal Bond or Alternative Security **[High]** (Mandatory · 2d)

5.1 Required for proposal responses with a value greater than \$500,000. *(N, Page 5)*

5.2 Executed by one or more surety companies authorized to do business in Virginia. *(N, Page 5)*

5.3 Amount not to exceed five percent (5%) of the amount offered or proposed. *(N, Page 5)*

5.4 Payable to the Commonwealth of Virginia, naming also the University. *(N, Page 5)*

5.5 Alternative forms include certified check, cash escrows, personal bond, property bond, or bank/savings institution's letter of credit (with approval). *(O, Page 5)*

6. References **[High]** (Mandatory · 1d)

6.1 Complete and submit requested account and reference information specified in Attachment A. *(P, Page 5)*

6.2 Provide a minimum of five (5) references. *(P, Page 5)*

6.3 Additional references may be included as a separate attachment. *(P, Page 5)*

6.4 If business conducted with Old Dominion University in past ten (10) years, ODU must be included as a named reference. *(P, Page 6)*

7. Technical Proposal **[High]** (Mandatory · 10d)

7.1 Solution for AI-driven enterprise site search and personalization. *(II, Page 6)*

7.2 Implementation, configuration, training, and support for a unified search experience across odu.edu and ODUGlobal web properties. *(II, Page 6)*

7.3 Improve content discovery, search relevance, accessibility, analytics, and tailored digital experiences. (II, Page 6)

7.4 Address unified, scalable search experience supporting cross-site indexing, improved relevance and tuning, natural-language/conversational search, actionable analytics, and accessibility monitoring. (III.B, Page 6)

8. Proprietary Information Identification [Medium] (Optional · 0d)

8.1 Written notice specifically identifying data or materials to be protected as trade secrets or proprietary information. (L.2, Page 4)

8.2 State reasons why protection is necessary. (L.3, Page 5)

8.3 Proprietary or trade secret material must be identified by distinct method (highlighting/underlining) indicating specific words, figures, or paragraphs. (L.3, Page 5)

8.4 Classification of entire proposal, line-item prices, or total proposal prices as proprietary is not acceptable. (L.4, Page 5)

9. Small Business and Supplier Diversity Certification [Low] (Optional · 0d)

9.1 Indicate if certified through the Commonwealth's Department of Small Business and Supplier Diversity. (Page 1)

9.2 If yes, provide SWAM Designation, Certification #, and Expiration Date. (Page 1)

Key Dates & Budget

Submission deadline	July 7, 2026 NLT 2:00 P.M. Local Time
Contract value	—
Payment terms	—
Insurance required	—
Bond required	Proposal bond required for responses with a value greater than \$500,000, not to exceed 5% of the amount offered.

Strengths

Strength	Note
Strong Alignment with Core Services	The RFP's focus on an 'AI-driven Enterprise Website Search and Personalization Solution' directly matches SPS's stated expertise in AI/ML-driven solutions (search, personalization, data platforms) and web application development.
Relevant Experience	SPS has 8 years of experience, which is sufficient for a project of this nature, especially given the specialized AI/ML and web development focus.
Capacity for Insurance Requirements	SPS has a maximum insurance availability of \$5,000,000, which is likely to meet or exceed any insurance requirements for this type of project, even though specific amounts are not detailed in the RFP.
Ability to Provide Audited Financials	SPS can provide audited financials, which is often a requirement for public sector bids and demonstrates financial stability and transparency.
Certifications	SPS's NIST 800-53 alignment and SOC 2 certifications are valuable for cybersecurity and data handling aspects, which are implicitly important for an enterprise search and personalization solution.

Risks / Weaknesses

Risk	Severity	Note
Tight Submission Deadline	HIGH	The RFP was issued on June 5, 2026, with a due date of July 7, 2026, allowing just over a month for proposal preparation and submission. This requires immediate resource allocation and efficient workflow.

Risk	Severity	Note
Proposal Bond Requirement	MEDIUM	A proposal bond (or alternative security) is required for bids over \$500,000, which represents an upfront financial commitment and administrative overhead. SPS needs to confirm if the expected contract value will exceed this threshold.
State Registration Requirement	MEDIUM	SPS is registered in its home state only and registers elsewhere on a per-bid basis. This RFP is for Old Dominion University in Virginia, meaning SPS will need to register with the Commonwealth's State Corporation Commission if not already, which adds a procedural step and potential delay.
Unspecified Contract Value	MEDIUM	The RFP does not specify an estimated contract value or budget, making it difficult to fully assess the financial scale and the exact implications of the proposal bond requirement without further information.
Unspecified Payment Terms	LOW	The RFP does not explicitly state payment terms. While SPS's acceptable terms are 30 days, this will need to be confirmed or negotiated, which could introduce minor delays or unfavorable terms if not addressed proactively.

Financial / Accounting Checklist

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Payment Terms	REVIEW	Payment terms aren't clearly stated in the RFP — confirm manually before proceeding.	Not cited in RFP
Financial Stability Requirements	REVIEW	The RFP states the University may conduct investigations to determine the Contractor's ability to perform services and may request information and data for this purpose, but it does not specifically require financial statements.	The University may make such reasonable investigations as deemed proper and necessary to determine the ability of the Contractor to perform the services/furnish the goods and the Contractor shall furnish to the University all such information and data for this purpose as may be requested. <i>(Page 2)</i>
Unaudited Financial Statements	REVIEW	The RFP does not specify whether audited or unaudited financial statements are required, as it does not explicitly request financial statements at all.	Not cited in RFP
Insurance Requirements	REVIEW	Insurance requirement isn't clearly stated in the RFP — confirm manually before proceeding.	Not cited in RFP
Profitability Analysis	REVIEW	The RFP does not provide any pricing structure or details that would allow for a profitability analysis.	Not cited in RFP

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Bid Bond	GO	A proposal bond is required for responses with a value greater than \$500,000, and SPS's services are likely to exceed this threshold, which is a standard requirement.	All proposal responses with a value greater than \$500,000 shall be accompanied by a 'proposal bond' executed by one or more surety companies selected by the Contractor that is authorized to do business in Virginia, as a guarantee that if the contract is awarded to the Contractor, Contractor will enter into the contract for the work specified in the proposal. (Page 5)

Legal Checklist

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Relevant Experience	REVIEW	The RFP requires a minimum of five references and allows the University to use past performance with them over the last ten years to determine responsibility, implying a need for relevant experience, but does not specify a minimum number of years of experience.	Contractors shall provide a minimum of five (5) references... If at any time during the past ten (10) years the Contractor and/or any of the Contractor's currently named principals has conducted business and/or held a contract agreement of any type with Old Dominion University... then Contractor shall include as a named reference, Old Dominion University. If Old Dominion University is named as a reference... then Contractor's past performance for any and all Old Dominion University contracts held and/or completed during the specified ten (10) year period may be used to determine a Contractor's responsibility and subsequent award of this contract. (Page 5)

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Registration Requirement	GO	The RFP explicitly asks if the company is registered with eVA and the Commonwealth's State Corporation Commission, and states that all contractors must register in eVA.	Are you or your company registered with eVA? _____ Yes _____ No eVA ID #: _____ Is your firm registered with the Commonwealth's State Corporation Commission (SEC)?... All Contractors desiring to provide goods and/or services to the Commonwealth must register here. Contractors must register in eVA and agree to pay the Supplier Transaction Fees specified on the eVA website. <i>(Page 1)</i>
Financial Statement of Previous Year	REVIEW	The RFP does not explicitly require the prior year's financial statement, but it does state that the University may conduct investigations to determine the contractor's ability to perform and may request information and data for this purpose.	The University may make such reasonable investigations as deemed proper and necessary to determine the ability of the Contractor to perform the services/furnish the goods and the Contractor shall furnish to the University all such information and data for this purpose as may be requested. <i>(Page 2)</i>
Qualified Personnel	REVIEW	The RFP does not explicitly specify qualified personnel or key staff requirements, but it does state that the University seeks a 'qualified partner' to implement, configure, train, and support the solution.	The University seeks a qualified partner to implement, configure, train, and support a unified search experience across odu.edu and ODUGlobal web properties. <i>(Page 6)</i>
Technical Knowhow	GO	The RFP clearly requires specific technical expertise in AI-driven enterprise website search and personalization solutions.	The purpose of this Request for Proposal (RFP) is to solicit proposals through competitive negotiation for an AI-driven enterprise site search and personalization solution for Old Dominion University. <i>(Page 6)</i>
Expected Revenue Generation	REVIEW	The RFP does not provide any pricing terms or information from which contract value or expected revenue can be estimated.	Not cited in RFP
Period of Implementation	REVIEW	The RFP mentions a 'Period of Contract' but does not define its duration or the implementation period for the solution.	Period of Contract: <i>(Page 1)</i>
Insurance Coverage	REVIEW	The RFP does not specify any required insurance coverages or amounts.	Not cited in RFP

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Compliance of Law	GO	The RFP requires compliance with several federal and state laws, including the Federal Civil Rights Act, Virginia Fair Employment Contracting Act, Virginians with Disabilities Act, Americans with Disabilities Act, and the federal Immigration Reform and Control Act.	They will conform to the provisions of the Federal Civil Rights Act of 1964, as amended, as well as the Virginia Fair Employment Contracting Act of 1975, as amended, where applicable, the Virginians with Disabilities Act, and the Americans with Disabilities Act. They do not and will not during the performance of any resulting contract employ illegal alien workers or otherwise violate the provision of the federal Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986. <i>(Page 3)</i>
Compliance Requirements (Data Protection)	GO	The RFP references the Virginia Freedom of Information Act regarding public inspection of materials and protection of trade secrets or proprietary information.	Materials and documentation originated and prepared for the University pursuant to this RFP shall belong exclusively to the university and be subject to public inspection in accordance with the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, Chapter 37 (§ 2.2-3700 et seq.) of Title 2.2 of the Code of Virginia. Trade secrets or proprietary information submitted by a Contractor shall not be subject to public disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act; however, the Contractor must invoke the protections of §23-38.90 of the Code of Virginia... <i>(Page 4)</i>
State Registration	GO	The RFP explicitly asks if the firm is registered with the Commonwealth's State Corporation Commission and requires registration with eVA, which is the state's procurement marketplace.	Is your firm registered with the Commonwealth's State Corporation Commission (SEC)?... All Contractors desiring to provide goods and/or services to the Commonwealth must register here. Contractors must register in eVA... <i>(Page 1)</i>
E-Verify	REVIEW	The RFP does not explicitly require participation in the E-Verify system, though it does require compliance with the federal Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986.	They do not and will not during the performance of any resulting contract employ illegal alien workers or otherwise violate the provision of the federal Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986. <i>(Page 3)</i>

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Contractual Obligations	REVIEW	The RFP does not define termination clauses, liability limits, or dispute resolution terms.	Not cited in RFP

Operations Checklist

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Insurance Requirement Form	REVIEW	The RFP does not explicitly state a requirement for a certificate of insurance or similar form to be submitted with the proposal. It does not mention any specific insurance coverage amounts.	Not cited in RFP
Information Form (Tax ID, Owner Name, % Ownership)	GO	The RFP requires the contractor to provide their FEI/FIN # and indicate if they are registered with the Commonwealth's State Corporation Commission, which aligns with providing basic company information.	FEI/FIN #: Phone: <i>(Page 1)</i>
Small Business Certification	GO	The RFP asks if the firm is certified through the Commonwealth's Department of Small Business and Supplier Diversity and requests details if applicable, indicating it is evaluated.	Are you or your firm certified through the Commonwealth's Department of Small Business and Supplier Diversity? Yes _____ No _____ If yes, please indicate the following: SWAM Designation: _____ _____ _____ Certification #: _____ Expiration Date: _____ _____ _____ <i>(Page 1)</i>
MBE Certification	REVIEW	The RFP asks about 'SWAM Designation' which includes Minority-Owned Business (MBE) but does not explicitly require or evaluate MBE certification as a standalone item.	SWAM Designation: _____ _____ _____ <i>(Page 1)</i>
Workers Comp Insurance	REVIEW	The RFP does not explicitly mention a requirement for Workers' Compensation insurance.	Not cited in RFP
Business with Iran	REVIEW	The RFP does not explicitly require a declaration regarding business dealings with sanctioned countries like Iran.	Not cited in RFP
Submission Deadlines	GO	The RFP clearly states the due date and time for proposals, emphasizing that late submissions will not be accepted.	Due Date and Time: July 7, 2026 NLT 2:00 P.M. Local Time (Time Stamped 2:01 P.M. or Later Will No Be Accepted <i>(Page 1)</i>

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Document Compliance	GO	The RFP provides clear instructions for identifying the proposal envelope and specifies that proposals time-stamped after the deadline will be returned unopened.	C. Identification of Proposal Envelope: The signed proposal should be returned in a separate envelope or package, sealed and identified as follows: From: Name of Contractor July 7, 2026 NLT 2:00 PM 26-ODU-30-JNH Address RFP Number AI-driven Enterprise Website Search and Personalization Solution City, State, Zip Code RFP Title Name of Procurement Officer: Janis Hall The envelope should be addressed as directed on Page 1 of the solicitation. Proposals may be hand delivered to the designated location in the office issuing the solicitation. No other correspondence or other proposals should be placed in the envelope. <i>(Page 2)</i>
Signatory Authority	GO	The RFP specifies that an agent authorized to bind the company must sign the proposal.	An Agent authorized to bind the company to same shall sign the following section. Name and Address of Contractor: Date: By: Signature Name: Typed or Printed (Name and Title) <i>(Page 1)</i>
Vendor Registration	GO	The RFP explicitly states that all contractors desiring to provide goods and/or services to the Commonwealth must register in eVA and agree to pay the Supplier Transaction Fees.	All Contractors desiring to provide goods and/or services to the Commonwealth must register here. Contractors must register in eVA and agree to pay the Supplier Transaction Fees specified on the eVA website. <i>(Page 4)</i>

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Checklist of Required Documents	REVIEW	The RFP mentions specific forms like Attachment A for references and requires a proposal bond for values over \$500,000, but it does not provide a consolidated checklist of all required documents.	P. References: Contractors shall complete and submit with response the requested account and reference information specified herein in Attachment A. Contractor shall provide a minimum of five (5) references, however, additional references may be included as a separate attachment incorporated into the response. N. Proposal Bonds: (the Rules §28.) All proposal responses with a value greater than \$500,000 shall be accompanied by a 'proposal bond' executed by one or more surety companies selected by the Contractor that is authorized to do business in Virginia, as a guarantee that if the contract is awarded to the Contractor, Contractor will enter into the contract for the work specified in the proposal. (Page 5)

Technical Checklist

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Scope of Services/Products Alignment	GO	The RFP's core requirement for an AI-driven enterprise website search and personalization solution directly aligns with SPS's stated services, which include AI/ML-driven solutions for search and personalization, and web application development and integration.	The purpose of this Request for Proposal (RFP) is to solicit proposals through competitive negotiation for an AI-driven enterprise site search and personalization solution for Old Dominion University. (Page 6)
Technical Requirements	GO	The RFP's technical specifications, such as unified search experience, cross-site indexing, improved relevance, natural-language search, and actionable analytics, are well within SPS's capabilities, especially given its expertise in AI/ML-driven solutions and web application development.	The desired future state includes a unified, scalable search experience that can support cross-site indexing; improved relevance and tuning; natural-language or conversational search experiences; actionable analytics on top queries, zero-result searches, and click behavior; accessibility monitoring (Page 6)

Item	Status	Reason	Evidence from RFP
Compliance with Industry Standards	REVIEW	The RFP does not explicitly state specific industry standards for compliance, such as NIST, beyond general legal and ethical certifications. While SPS is NIST 800-53 aligned, the RFP does not require it.	Not addressed in the RFP
Security Considerations	REVIEW	The RFP mentions general data ownership and protection under the Virginia Freedom of Information Act but does not detail specific security requirements like encryption, access control, or data protection protocols for the solution itself. SPS offers cybersecurity solutions, but the RFP lacks specific requirements to evaluate against.	Materials and documentation originated and prepared for the University pursuant to this RFP shall belong exclusively to the university and be subject to public inspection in accordance with the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, Chapter 37 (§ 2.2-3700 et seq.) of Title 2.2 of the Code of Virginia. <i>(Page 4)</i>
Integration Needs	GO	The RFP explicitly states the need for a unified search experience across multiple web properties (odu.edu and ODUGlobal), indicating a clear requirement for integration, which aligns with SPS's web application development and integration services.	The University seeks a qualified partner to implement, configure, train, and support a unified search experience across odu.edu and ODUGlobal web properties. <i>(Page 6)</i>